Lucas Cain

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Education

University of Chicago
- Ph.D. Student in Political Science
  Fields: American Politics, Quantitative Methods
- MA in Political Science 2026

University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill
- B.A. Political Science, *highest honors* 2022
- B.S. Economics, *honors* 2022

Research

Publications
- Brave, Scott, **Lucas Cain**, Ross Cole, and Ezra Karger. "What's New in CARTS 2.1? Updates to Our Index Tracking National Retail Sales." Chicago Fed Insights, July 2024.
- Broady, Kristen, Anthony Barr, Darlene Booth-Bell, and Lucas Cain. "Racial Wealth Gains and Gaps: Nine Facts About the Disparities." Chicago Fed Insights, 2024.
- Cain, Lucas, Danae Hernandez-Cortes, Christopher Timmins, and Paige Weber. "Recent Findings and Methodologies in Economics Research in Environmental Justice." Review of Environmental Economics and Policy 18, no. 1 (2024): 116–42.
- Butcher, Kristin F., Lucas Cain, Camilo García-Jimeno, and Ryan Perry. Immigration and the Labor Market in the Post-Pandemic Recovery.Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, October 9, 2023.

Works in Progress
- Cain, Lucas "By Loyalty and Leverage: Presidential Influence at the Federal Reserve"
- Cain, Lucas and Jon Rogowski "Civil Service Reform and the Organization of the Federal Government"
- Cain, Lucas and Andy Eggers "Misaligned Voting: Convex Hull Estimator"
- Cain, Lucas and Kevin Angell "Not by Popular Demand: Public Attitudes Towards Government Service Provision"

Teaching

University of Chicago

As Head Teaching Assistant
- Introduction to Quantiative Social Science (Autumn 2025)
  Level: PhD
  Instructor: Isaac Melhaff
- Math and Computation Bootcammp (Summer 2025, Summer 2026)
  Level: PhD

As Teaching Assistant
- Intro to American Politics (Autumn 2026)
  Level: Undergraduate
  Instructor: Ruth Bloch-Rubin
- The American Presidency (Spring 2026)
  Level: Undergraduate
  Instructor: Jon Rogowski

University of North Carolina

As Teaching Assistant

- Modern Political Thought (Summer 2020)
  Level: Undergraduate
  Instructor: Devin Christenson

Academic Employment

- 2024-Present: Replication Assistant, Quarterly Journal of Political Science, University of Chicago
  - Replicate code and results for all accepted articles to ensure accuracy of results and concordance with described procedures
- 2025: Research Assistant, Cathy Cohen
  - Literature review and advising on celebrity endorsement
- 2024-Present: Research Assistant, Jon Rogowski
  - Data collection and synthesis for early US federal employee records

Presentations

- "By Loyalty and Leverage: Presidential Influence at the Federal Reserve", Center for Effective Government, 2026.
- "Not by Popular Demand: Public Attitudes Towards Government Service Provision", American Politics Workshop, 2026.
- "By Loyalty and Leverage: Presidential Influence at the Federal Reserve, American Politics Workshop", 2025.

Private Sector and Government Employment

Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, 2022-2024

- Research Assistant, FOMC Policy and Communications

BalBrenner Law, 2021-2022

- Research Assistant

Technical Skills

- R, STATA, Python, ArcGIS, LaTeX

Service

University of Chicago

- 2026-Present: Founder, American Politics Working Group
- 2026-Present: Organizer, Political Science Association
- 2026-Present: Coordinator, American Politics Workshop
- 2026-Present: Area Chief Steward, Graduate Student Union
- 2026-Present: Dean's Advisory Committee
- 2026: Student Representative, American Politics Hiring Committee
- 2024-2026: Steward, Graduate Student Union

References

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Andrew Eggers
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Ruth Bloch Rubin
Associate Professor
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